SILENT CITY

Story Mode Side-Scroller Redesign Prompt



Reference rule: This concept image communicates only the broad side-scrolling direction. Its artwork, tiles, objects, colors, enemies, backgrounds, and exact placements must not be used. The implementation must use only assets already present in the Silent City project.

This PDF combines the planning image and the complete implementation prompt in one document.

Silent City - Story Mode Side-Scroller Redesign Prompt

Use the concept drawing embedded on the first page of this PDF **only to understand the general side-scrolling idea**. The PDF is self-contained and must not depend on the original laptop path.

Do not use, import, crop, trace, reproduce, or recreate any tiles, objects, characters, enemies, backgrounds, colors, textures, decorations, lighting, UI, or other visual content from this drawing. Do not treat its exact object or enemy placements as mandatory. It is only a communication reference for the basic gameplay direction: a 2D side view, mostly left-to-right movement, ground near the bottom, and progressive encounters.

Use **only tiles, objects, characters, enemies, backgrounds, decorations, effects, animations, and other assets that already exist inside the Silent City project**. Do not download external assets, generate replacement artwork, copy assets from another game, or create picture-based substitutes. Recombine and configure the project's existing resources to build the new layouts.

Portable file-reference rule

Whenever this prompt or later level-design work refers to another PDF, image, tileset, asset folder, scene, or supporting document, write the reference as a **relative path from the current document or agreed project root**. Never write a fixed drive letter, Windows username, home folder, or computer-specific absolute path. Keep the referenced files together in the same portable folder structure so the documents continue to work after being copied to another computer.

Source hierarchy

Use these documents as narrative references. They are stored beside this PDF in the same `Level_Design_Documents` folder:

- `silent_city_storyline_english.pdf`
- `silent_city_storyline_georgian.pdf`

The English and Georgian storyline PDFs describe the same story and are the authoritative source for characters, history, motivations, campaign order, boss roles, and ending. Preserve their meaning while adapting delivery and gameplay to a side-scrolling format.

The following user-approved updates override older names or location details in those documents:

- The official three level names are **Outer Graveyard**, **Forgotten Path**, and **Wizard's Sanctum**.
- The third level is the Wizard's Sanctum, not a castle.
- Skeletons are recurring enemies available for the campaign.
- The Minotaur is a guardian/mini-boss, not the final boss.
- The Wizard is the final boss of the story mode.

The following are old design documents and are **not authoritative requirements**:

- `silent_city_story_mode_design_ideas.pdf`
- `silent_city_story_mode_design_ideas_georgian.pdf`

They may be consulted for context, but do not automatically reuse their enemy counts, exact encounters, difficulty structure, platform placement, lighting rules, or other gameplay decisions. New details will be designed and approved separately for each level.

Redesign **only Silent City's story mode** into a forward-moving 2D side-scrolling platform campaign. The player must travel mainly from left to right, with solid terrain forming a clear floor near the bottom of the screen. Enemies, hazards, short jumps, checkpoints, and story events should appear progressively as the player advances.

The campaign should be **slightly harder than the current story mode** and have a **darker, more threatening atmosphere**. Difficulty must come from thoughtful enemy placement, tighter timing, combined combat and traversal challenges, and fewer completely safe stretches-not from unfair damage, excessive enemy crowds, blind jumps, or unclear collisions. Preserve enough environmental lighting and visual contrast for the player to read platforms, enemies, hazards, and the forward route.

Critical scope rule

- Do not modify online mode, multiplayer logic, networking, online maps, online scenes, lobbies, synchronization code, matchmaking, or shared online resources.
- Before editing anything, identify which files and resources belong exclusively to story mode and which are shared with online mode.
- If a tileset, scene, script, collision resource, or other dependency is shared with online mode, duplicate the existing project resource for story mode and change only the story-mode copy. Do not replace it with artwork from the concept drawing.
- Preserve all existing online behavior and verify afterward that no online file or shared dependency was changed unintentionally.

Story that must be preserved

- Long ago, the Stone Golem, Ice Golem, and Ash Golem protected Silent City through physical strength rather than magic.
- A powerful Wizard arrived to control the ancient energy beneath the city. He corrupted the city, raised the dead, awakened the Minotaur as his servant, separated the three guardians, damaged their memories, and weakened their cores.
- The player chooses one of the three Golems. The chosen Golem awakens in the Outer Graveyard with a damaged core and incomplete memory.
- While moving toward the Wizard, the Golem discovers that the city is being deliberately controlled and that restoring its own core is necessary.
- The Golem crosses the deep, dark Forgotten Path and reaches the Wizard's Sanctum. The Minotaur serves as a guardian/mini-boss before the final confrontation.
- After defeating the Minotaur, the Golem confronts the Wizard, who relies on teleportation, barriers, arena manipulation, and corrupted energy.
- The Golem destroys the corrupted core that powers the Wizard, defeats him, restores its memory and purpose, and allows light to return to Silent City.

- Preserve the ending idea that the guardians were created to protect the people and future of the city, and preserve the final exchange about choosing what is worth protecting.

Side-scrolling campaign structure

Adapt the preserved storyline into three connected side-scrolling story levels using the project's existing assets. This is a high-level campaign framework only. Do not lock exact layouts, enemy counts, checkpoint counts, jump measurements, or encounter compositions until each level is designed individually with the user.

1. Outer Graveyard

- A readable but tense tutorial level in dark, foggy dawn light.
- The selected Golem awakens with a damaged core and incomplete memories.
- Introduce movement, jumping, combat, skeleton enemies, the corrupted dead, and the first evidence that the city is being controlled.
- Progress mainly left-to-right toward the Forgotten Path.
- Decide exact encounters, hazards, checkpoints, and exit structure later during the Level 1 design phase.

2. Forgotten Path

- A deep, dark, oppressive underground or ruined passage with more difficult traversal while keeping the main route left-to-right.
- Use skeletons in harder positions and combinations than in the Outer Graveyard.
- Show how the Wizard's power damaged the old road and made sections of the route unstable.
- Reveal that the guardians were separated, their memories broken, and their cores weakened because the Wizard feared them.
- Let the Golem understand that restoring its core is the path to reaching and defeating the Wizard.
- Build toward the Minotaur as a guardian/mini-boss near the end of the level or at the approach to the Sanctum.
- Decide exact enemies, unstable-platform mechanics, hazards, checkpoints, Minotaur arena, and transition into the Sanctum later during the Level 2 design phase.

3. Wizard's Sanctum

- The darkest and most difficult level, inside the Wizard's corrupted Sanctum, with strong silhouettes and localized light around important gameplay elements.
- Use skeleton guards, Sanctum traps, difficult platforming, and magical hazards during the approach.
- Build toward the Wizard confrontation and the corrupted core that gives him power.
- Express the Wizard's magical fighting style through teleportation, barriers, arena changes, and corrupted energy while keeping the Golem's victory rooted in endurance and physical strength.
- Finish with the Wizard's defeat, the darkness lifting, the Golem's restored memory, the final exchange, and the credits.
- The Wizard is the final boss. Decide exact traversal, Sanctum rooms, arena geometry, boss phases, checkpoints, and ending presentation later during the Level 3 design phase.

Level-design rules

- The camera and progression must communicate forward movement from left to right.
- Keep the main walkable ground near the bottom of the screen.
- Use elevated platforms sparingly for jumps, secrets, enemy positioning, and hazards; do not create maze-like or floating-island-heavy maps.
- Keep jumps readable and fair. Avoid blind landings and unavoidable damage.
- Introduce one mechanic at a time, demonstrate it safely, then combine it with enemies or hazards.
- Use checkpoints before major difficulty spikes and boss encounters.
- Prevent backtracking unless it serves a short secret or story beat.
- Use environmental storytelling, brief dialogue triggers, lighting changes, and background details without stopping movement too often.
- Preserve the existing choice of playable Golem and its current movement/combat abilities unless a small story-mode-only adjustment is required for fair platforming.

Existing project assets, tilesets, collisions, and scene work

- Rebuild the current story-map layouts using only tiles, objects, decorations, characters, enemies, effects, and backgrounds already available in the project.
- First inventory the existing project assets and choose suitable combinations for the graveyard, deep Forgotten Path, and Wizard's Sanctum. Do not introduce new visual assets.
- The concept drawing is not an asset source. Do not use its pixels, imitate its tiles, or recreate its objects.
- Configure terrain/auto-tiling cleanly for ground edges, corners, walls, ledges, gaps, and decorative variants.
- Rebuild collision shapes to match visible surfaces closely. Remove invisible snags, collision gaps, unintended one-way behavior, and collisions on purely decorative tiles.
- Use one-way collisions only for platforms the player is intended to jump through from below.
- If falling platforms or similar unstable terrain are approved during a level-design phase, give them clear warning feedback, consistent behavior, and a reliable reset.
- Separate gameplay collision layers for player, terrain, enemies, hazards, triggers, checkpoints, and story-only interactables where practical.
- Keep decorative background art non-collidable.
- Add kill/reset volumes below real gaps and hazards, with safe checkpoint respawning.

Difficulty progression

- Overall target: moderately challenging and slightly harder than the current story mode, but consistently fair and learnable.
- Level 1: forgiving opening, then closer enemy spacing, basic enemy combinations, and less uninterrupted safe ground toward the exit.
- Level 2: stronger enemy pressure, more demanding traversal, and combined movement/combat challenges using mechanics approved during the Level 2 design phase.
- Level 3: the highest difficulty, with Sanctum traps, precise but fair hazards, skeleton guards, and a multi-stage final Wizard arena based on learned mechanics.

- Increase difficulty through enemy behavior, encounter composition, hazard timing, and arena design-not by filling the screen with large enemy crowds.
- Telegraph every dangerous attack and platform failure clearly enough for a first-time player to react or learn from the mistake.

Dark atmosphere and gameplay readability

- Make every story level darker than before, using the project's existing lighting, backgrounds, tiles, decorations, fog, particles, and effects only.
- Build an ominous atmosphere with restrained ambient light, deep shadows, fog, ruined silhouettes, and small pools of warm or corrupted light.
- Keep the player, enemies, platform edges, gaps, hazards, checkpoints, and exits visually readable at all times.
- Use existing lanterns or other available light-emitting objects to guide forward movement and mark safe ground.
- Do not make difficulty depend on hiding essential platforms or enemies in complete darkness.
- Increase darkness gradually: Outer Graveyard is dim but readable, Forgotten Path is deep, dark, and oppressive, and Wizard's Sanctum is the darkest and most dangerous area.

One-level-at-a-time workflow

1. Audit the project and list story-only scenes/scripts/resources versus online/shared files.
2. Confirm the high-level campaign and story conversion without implementing all three levels at once.
3. Start with **Level 1: Outer Graveyard**. Inspect relevant existing assets and mechanics, then propose its detailed side-scrolling layout, story beats, encounters, hazards, checkpoints, and exact files to change.
4. Wait for user approval of the Level 1 plan before implementing it.
5. Implement and fully test Level 1 with every playable Golem, including collisions, deaths, respawns, camera bounds, story triggers, and the transition to Level 2.
6. Only after Level 1 is approved and complete, repeat the same design, approval, implementation, and testing process for **Level 2: Forgotten Path**.
7. Only after Level 2 is approved and complete, repeat the process for **Level 3: Wizard's Sanctum**, including skeleton guards, Sanctum hazards, the final Wizard boss, corrupted core, ending, and credits.
8. After every level, run regression checks on online mode and confirm it remains unchanged.

Acceptance criteria

- All three story levels play primarily left-to-right, with ground mainly near the bottom. They do not need to visually resemble the drawing.
- The storyline, character roles, campaign order, revelations, bosses, and ending remain faithful to the storyline PDFs.
- Old design-idea details are not treated as mandatory unless the user approves them during the relevant level-design phase.
- The ground is mainly along the bottom, with readable platforms and progressive enemy encounters.
- The campaign is noticeably but reasonably harder than the current story mode.

- All three levels have a darker atmosphere while essential gameplay information remains clearly visible.
- Every visible tile, object, character, enemy, background, decoration, effect, and animation comes from the existing Silent City project.
- No visual content from the concept drawing or another game is imported, copied, traced, or recreated.
- Story mode can be completed from start to ending without soft locks, broken transitions, unfair jumps, or collision traps.
- Tiles and collision shapes align correctly.
- Any falling platforms, checkpoints, and other level-specific mechanics approved for a level work reliably.
- Each playable Golem can complete every required jump and boss arena.
- No online-mode file, behavior, scene, resource, or network system is modified or broken.
- Provide a final list of changed files and test results, including explicit confirmation that online mode remained untouched.

Use the drawing only to understand the side-scrolling gameplay idea. Do not use it as final art, an art-style reference, a tileset reference, or an exact level blueprint. Use only assets already present in the Silent City project, and do not copy Mario characters, branded blocks, pipes, enemies, logos, or other protected visual designs.